ARBITER Direct support Context Inference

D1 Low

1.2 … concealed until participants were enrolled …? Yes

Direct support · CIRCULATIONAHA.121.057639.pdf · p 3 · L46–50 · 592b9a6c53

(1) Bound span

… web-based interactive response system. The assignment to each treatment group was computer-generated and … by means of a permuted-block sequence with variable block size.

Justification Patients were randomized using a web-based interactive response system…

Unknown: Whether the central system was run by a unit independent of enrolling staff is not stated explicitly.

(4) Recorded gap

D2 Low

2.1 Were participants aware of their assigned intervention …? Yes

Direct support · ClinicalTrials.gov NCT02436655 · p 1 · L67–68 · d32e23eb2a

Masking: NONE

Justification The registry lists masking as NONE…

2.4, 2.5, 2.7 not asked — RoB 2 branching

(2) Branching

D3 Low

3.1 Were data … available for all, or nearly all, participants …? Yes

Direct support · ehae585.pdf · p 6 · L26–32 · a890f771fd

All patients were included in the analysis. … One patient, who was randomized to early surgery, has been lost to follow-up, and this patient was censored…

Justification so 1/157 (0.6%) has incomplete outcome data.

D4 Low

4.3 Were outcome assessors aware of the intervention received …? Yes

Direct support · ehae585.pdf · p 3 · L1–116 · a890f771fd

Data and safety monitoring board members were not blinded to the treatment allocation during events review.

Justification the report states that DSMB members were not blinded to allocation when reviewing events.

4.4 … influenced by knowledge …? Probably no

All-cause death is an observer-reported outcome that involves no judgement…

D5 Some concerns

5.1 … pre-specified analysis plan … before unblinded outcome data …? No information

Context · CIRCULATIONAHA.121.057639.pdf · p 4 · L16–35 · 592b9a6c53

Prespecified secondary end points included the following: … Time to death

Context · ClinicalTrials.gov NCT02436655 · p 1 · L95–101 · d32e23eb2a

Primary outcome 1: all cause death, Major Adverse Cardiac Event (MACE) including: …

Justification names all-cause death only as a component of composite outcomes.

No dated source therefore specifies this measurement and analysis.

5.1 NI · 5.2 PN · 5.3 PN → official algorithm

(3) Algorithm

Proposed Some concerns → Adopted Some concerns (no override)

Overall **D1–D4 Low · D5 Some concerns →** Some concerns

Official RoB 2 overall rule: any Some concerns; applied by the server **Bundle verifier: verified**

Published: Low **Adjudicators: Some concerns** **Unassisted: Low**